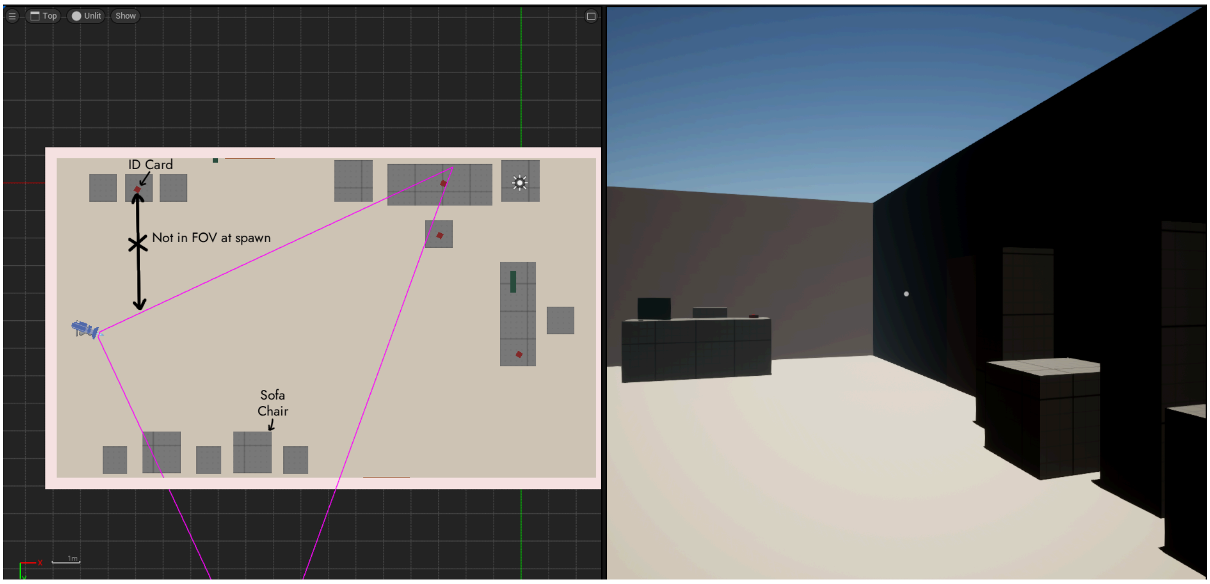
Solving Discoverability Through Iteration

Phase 1: The Blind Spot (V1)

Establishing the Primary Item (ID Card)

The Problem: 20% Interaction Rate
Upon spawning, players naturally moved forward into the room to explore. The critical item (ID Card) was placed on a side table, located outside the player's immediate Field of View (FOV).

Analysis: Without leading lines, players ignored the periphery and moved toward the largest object in the room (the Sofa Chair), missing the ID card entirely.



The Fix: The "Anchor" Placement
I relocated the ID card to the Sofa Chair directly in front of the spawn point.

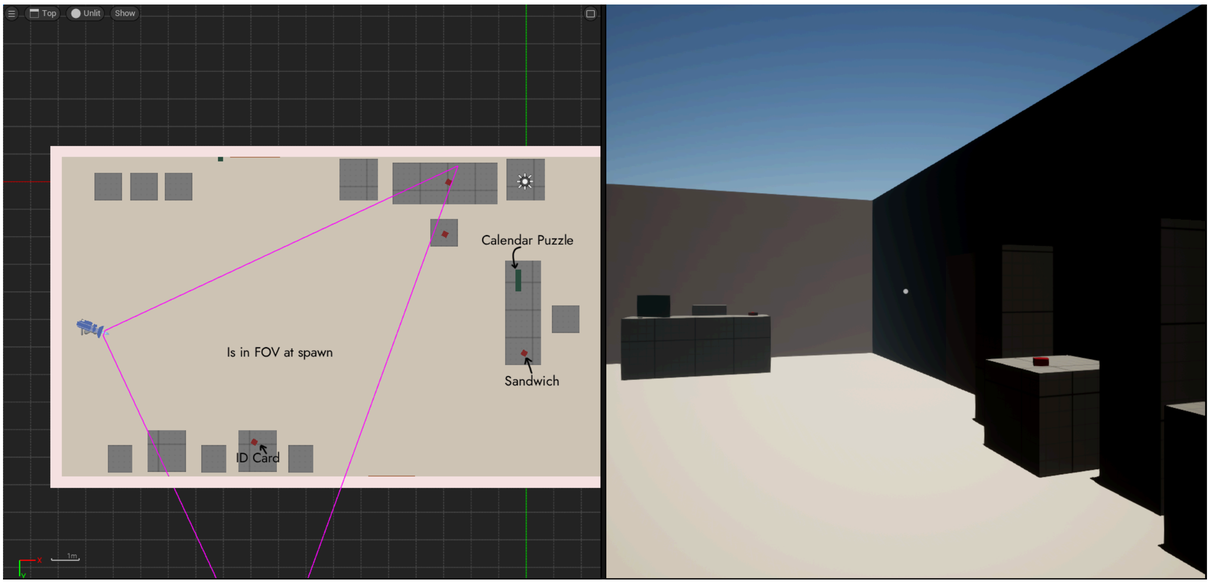
Result: The ID card became the first thing the player saw. Interaction rate rose to **93%**, allowing players to progress.

Phase 2: The "Sandwich Trap" (V2)

The Distraction Issue

The Problem: The Desk Hierarchy
With the ID card acquired, players moved to the Reception Desk. There is a sandwich (a story actor) placed on the desk to add detail.

Analysis: The sandwich had high contrast and recognizable shape. Players interacted with it, assumed the desk was completely explored, and left. They missed the Calendar completely.



The Partial Fix: I moved the sandwich to a different table to de-clutter the critical path.

The Issue: While this improved visibility slightly, the Calendar was still being missed.

Player Feedback: More importantly, testers reported that the level felt "empty and lacking detail." The gameplay loop was too basic: walk up, click calendar, get code. It failed to scratch the "Escape Room" itch or provide a satisfying challenge.

Phase 3: The Mechanical Solution (Final)

Analysis & Dynamic Affordance

The Analysis (Why was it still missed?): Investigating the V2 failure, I realized that even without the sandwich, the Calendar blended into the background. It was a flat, static object. The player needed a trigger to signal that this specific object was interactable.

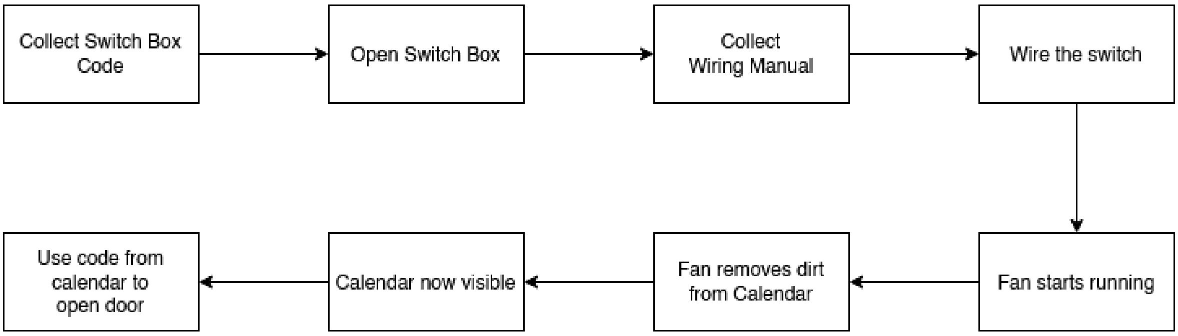
The Solution: The Fan Puzzle
To solve both the visibility issue and the "empty level" feedback, I introduced a mechanical dependency.

- **The Setup:** The Calendar is now covered in dust (obscuring the code).
- **The Puzzle:** A broken fan stands besides the desk. The player must repair the fan to clear the dust.

The Logic Flow (Critical Path):

1. **Obstacle:** Code is unreadable due to dust.

2. **Action:** Player repairs the Fan.
3. **Visual Cue:** The Fan turns on, blowing wind across the desk.
4. **Payoff:** The wind clears the dust and causes the Calendar pages to flutter.



The Outcome: 100% Success Rate
The fluttering pages created a dynamic "Look At Me" signal (motion attracts the eye), solving the visibility issue. Simultaneously, the repair mechanic added the necessary depth to the escape room experience.